

WhatsApp AI Setup Guide

A simple, secure, step-by-step guide to connect your WhatsApp Business number and let your VerityCore AI assistant reply to customers.

What you will achieve

Your Meta app will deliver incoming WhatsApp messages to VerityCore AI. Your assistant will answer automatically using your approved business profile and knowledge sources.

Receiving

Healthy

AI replies active

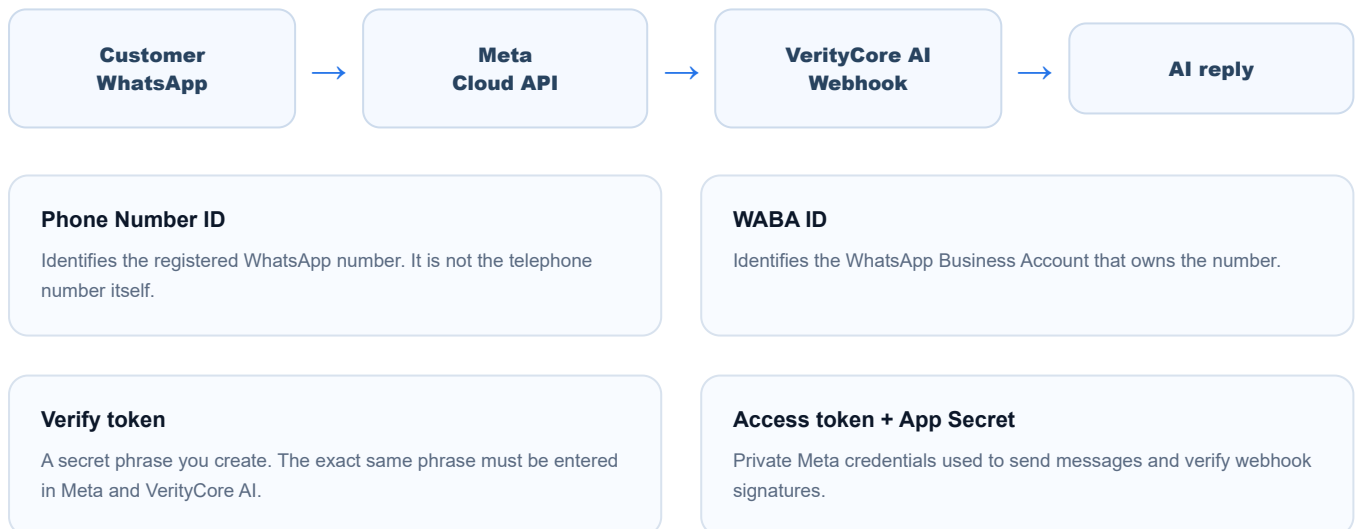
Prepare these items

Allow about 20–40 minutes. Meta may take longer to review business details or a display name.

- ✓ A Meta account with administrator access to your organisation's Business Portfolio.
- ✓ A Meta Developer app connected to the **WhatsApp Business Platform** .
- ✓ A business phone number that can receive an SMS or voice verification code. Use the international format, +263... .
for example
- ✓ A VerityCore AI workspace where you can manage WhatsApp settings.
- ✓ Your public website, privacy-policy URL, terms URL, data-deletion instructions, support email, and a square 1024 × 1024 app icon.

Security first: never email, screenshot, or paste an access token or App Secret into a chat. In this guide, sensitive values are blurred or replaced by dots. If a token is exposed, revoke it and create a new one immediately.

The connection in one picture





Create and prepare your Meta app

- 1 Open **Meta for Developers** , select **My Apps** , and create a Business app.
- 2 Add the **WhatsApp / Connect on WhatsApp** use case.
- 3 In **App settings** → **Basic** , add your app icon, contact email, website domain, privacy policy, terms, and user-data deletion URL.
- 4 Complete any items shown under **Required actions** and business verification.
- 5 When ready for real inbound messages, use **Publish** to switch the app to Live.

Important: while a Meta app is unpublished, Meta normally sends only dashboard test webhooks. Real messages sent to your business number may show delivery ticks but never reach the AI.

developers.facebook.com/apps/...../settings/basic

Meta

App settings · Basic

App ID
Public identifier

App secret
Never share this value

Privacy policy and data deletion
Use pages on your own website

App icon
Square 1024 × 1024 PNG or JPG

Complete

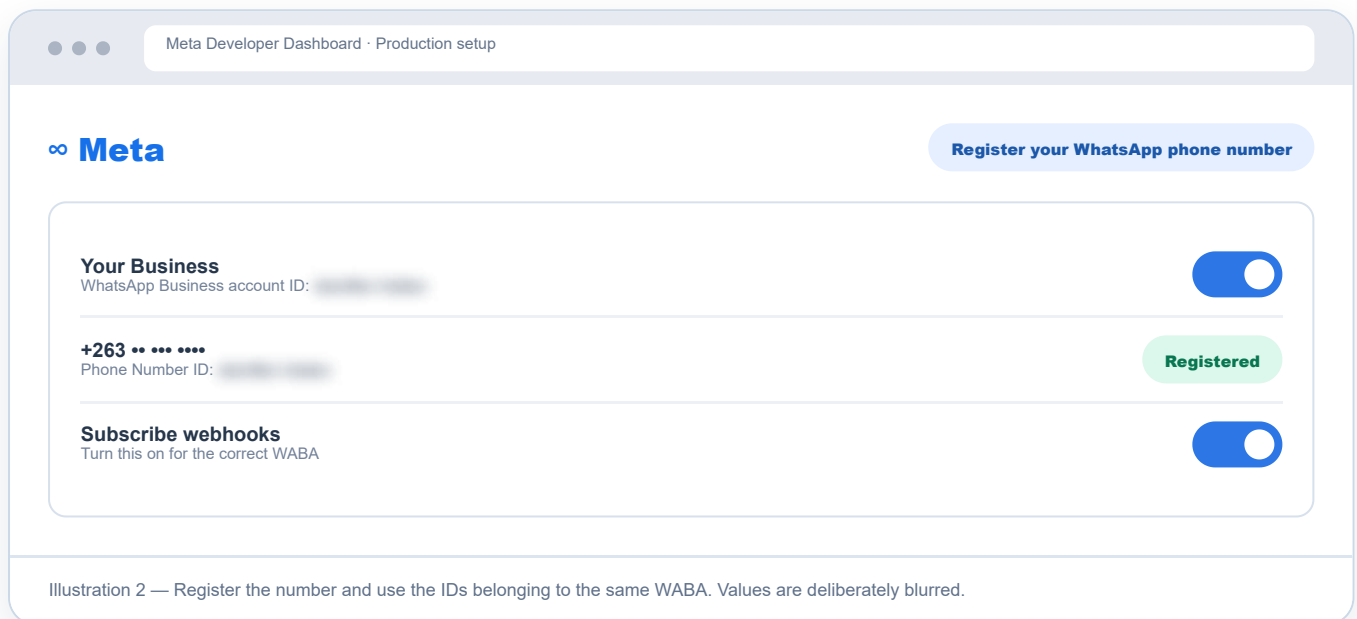
Uploaded

Illustration 1 — Complete the Basic settings before publishing. All identifying values shown here are masked.



Register your WhatsApp number

- 1 In your Meta app, open **WhatsApp** → **API Setup** or **Production setup**.
- 2 Select the correct Business Portfolio and WhatsApp Business Account (WABA).
- 3 Add your business phone number and complete the SMS or voice verification.
- 4 Wait until the number **Registered**. Copy the **Phone Number ID** and **WhatsApp Business Account ID**.

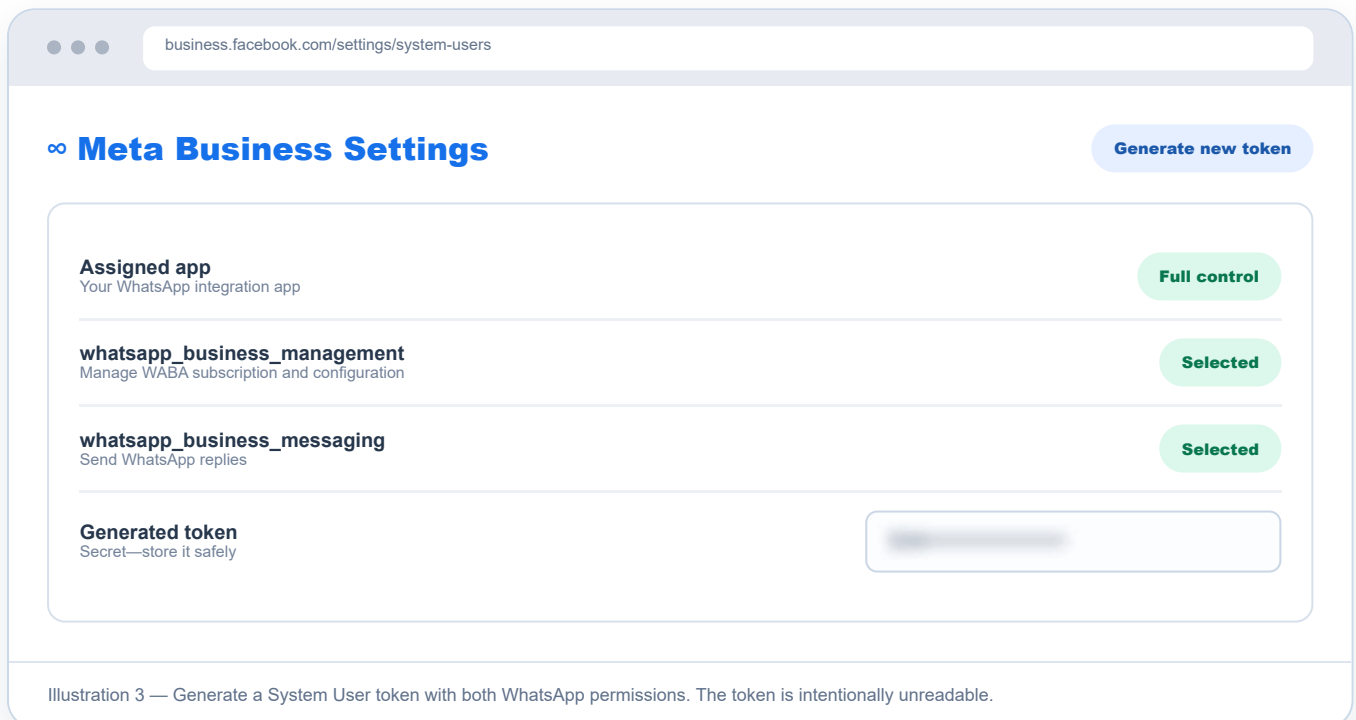


Tip: if Meta lists more than one WABA, double-check the business name, number, WABA ID, and Phone Number ID. Mixing IDs from different accounts prevents inbound replies.

Create a secure access token

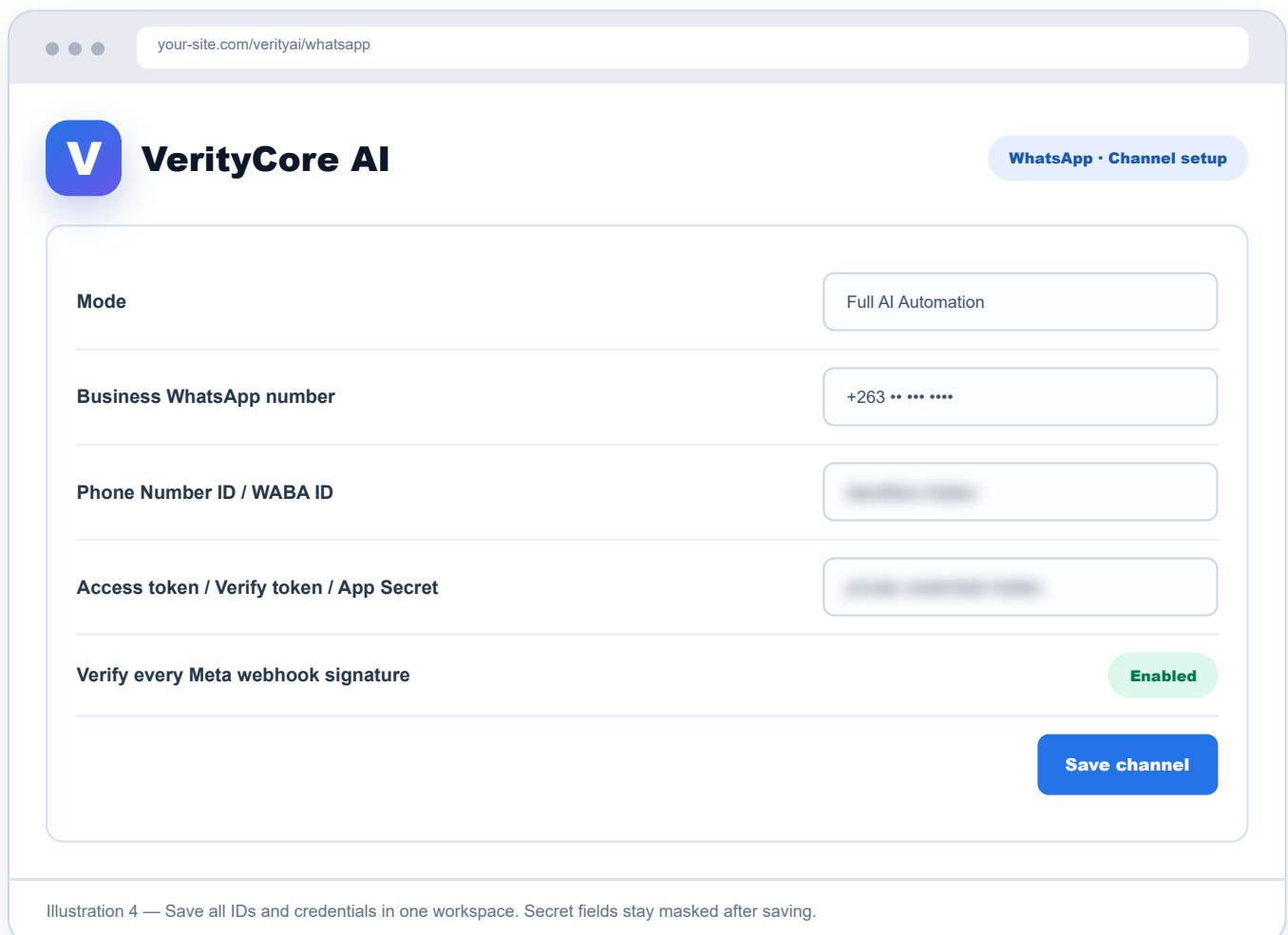
Use a System User token for production. The short-lived token shown in Meta’s “Try it out” area is useful only for temporary testing.

- 1 Open **Meta Business Settings** → **Users** → **System users** .
- 2 Create or select an Admin system user. Assign your Meta app and WhatsApp Business Account with the required access.
- 3 Generate a token for the same Meta app. `whatsapp_business_management` and `whatsapp_business_messaging` . Enable
- 4 Copy the token once and store it in a password manager. Do not place it in documents or screenshots.
- 5 In Meta App settings, copy the **App Secret** privately. You will paste it into VerityCore AI later.



Save the channel in VerityCore AI

- 1 Open your VerityCore AI workspace and go to **WhatsApp** .
- 2 Select **Full AI Automation** if you want the assistant to reply automatically.
- 3 Enter the business number in international format, then paste the Phone Number ID and WABA ID copied from Meta.
- 4 Open **Meta credentials** . Paste the access token and App Secret.
- 5 Create a long, random **Verify token** . Save it in your password manager—you must enter the exact same value in Meta.
- 6 Keep **Verify every Meta webhook signature** enabled, then click **Save channel** .



your-site.com/verityai/whatsapp

V VerityCore AI **WhatsApp · Channel setup**

Mode Full AI Automation

Business WhatsApp number +263

Phone Number ID / WABA ID [masked]

Access token / Verify token / App Secret [masked]

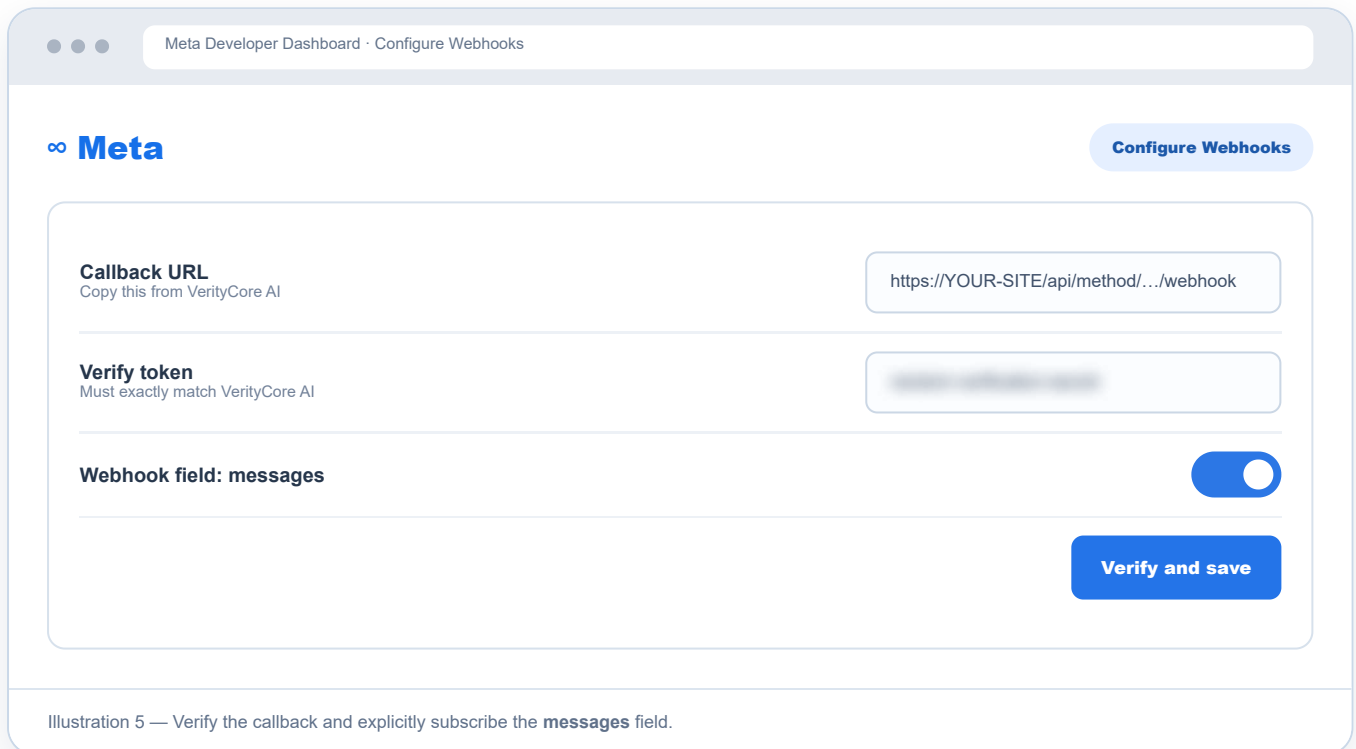
Verify every Meta webhook signature Enabled

Save channel

Illustration 4 — Save all IDs and credentials in one workspace. Secret fields stay masked after saving.

Connect the Meta webhook

- 1 On the VerityCore AI WhatsApp page, click **Copy URL** in the Webhook endpoint panel.
- 2 In Meta, open **WhatsApp** → **Configuration** → **Configure Webhooks** .
- 3 Paste the URL into **Callback URL** .
- 4 Enter the exact Verify token you created in VerityCore AI. It is case-sensitive.
- 5 Leave client-certificate attachment off unless your organisation specifically uses mTLS. Click **Verify and save** .
- 6 In **Webhook fields** , find `messages` and switch it to **Subscribed** .



Meta Developer Dashboard · Configure Webhooks

Meta Configure Webhooks

Callback URL
Copy this from VerityCore AI

Verify token
Must exactly match VerityCore AI

Webhook field: messages ☒

Verify and save

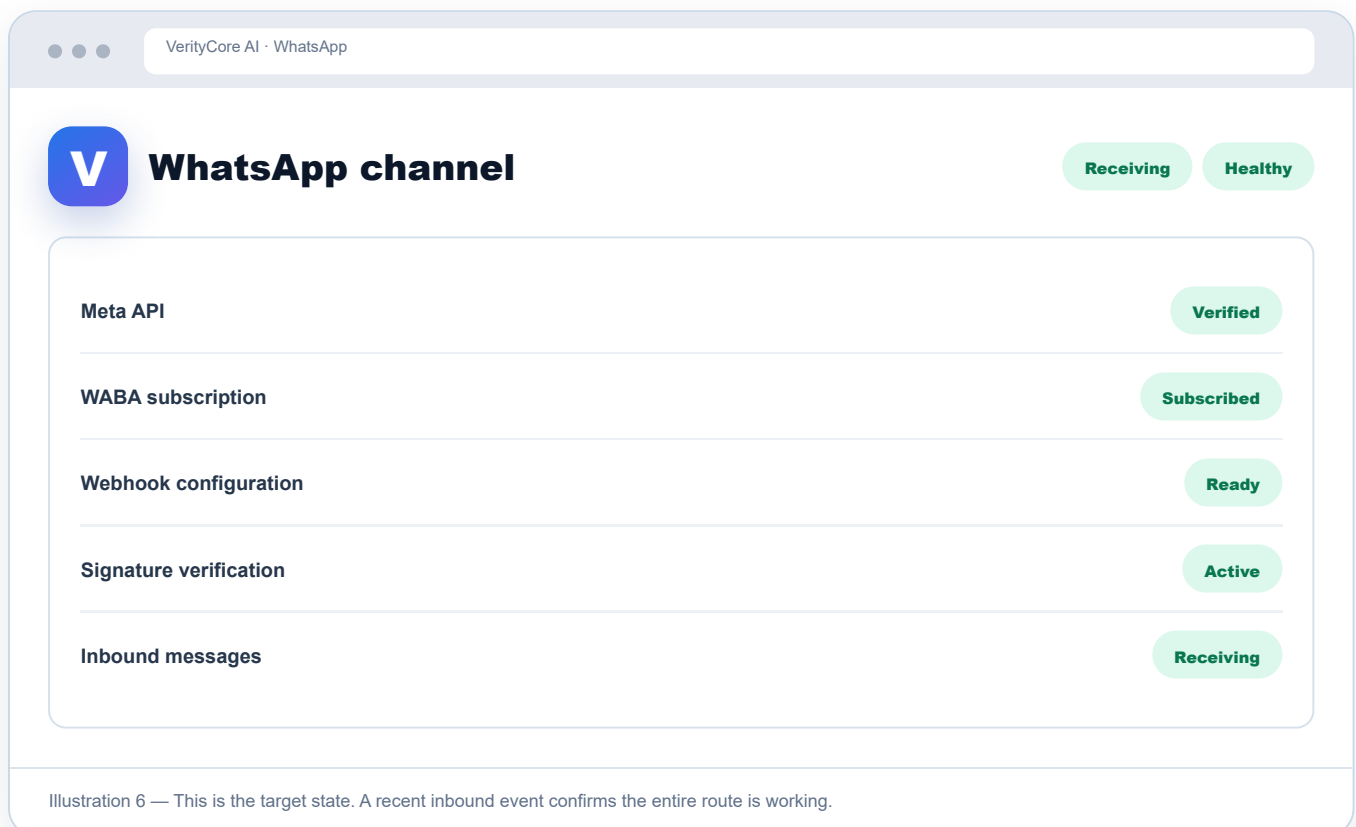
Illustration 5 — Verify the callback and explicitly subscribe the `messages` field.

A verified callback alone is not enough. The `messages` field must also be subscribed or the AI will never see customer messages.



Subscribe the WABA and test

- 1 In Meta's Production setup, turn on **Subscribe webhooks** for the correct WABA. You may also click **Subscribe WABA** in VerityCore AI.
- 2 Back in VerityCore AI, click **Test Meta API** . Resolve any token, permission, or ID error shown.
- 3 Use a **different personal WhatsApp number** to message your registered business number. Do not test by sending the business number to itself.
- 4 Send a simple message such as "Hello". Wait a few seconds for the AI reply.
- 5 Refresh the VerityCore AI page. The channel should show **Receiving** and **Healthy** .



WhatsApp's 24-hour window: after a customer messages you, the AI may reply normally during the customer-service window. Business-initiated messages outside that window generally require an approved message template.

If messages do not receive an AI reply

What you see	Likely cause	What to do
WhatsApp shows two ticks, but VerityCore AI says "Awaiting event".	Meta is not delivering inbound webhooks.	Publish the app, subscribe the <code>messages</code> field, and enable the correct WABA's webhook toggle.
"Invalid verify token" or callback verification fails.	The two Verify token values do not match.	Re-enter the same case-sensitive value in Meta and VerityCore AI, save, then verify again.
Meta API test fails with a permissions error.	The access token lacks the required scopes or WABA asset access.	Create a System User token with both WhatsApp permissions and assign the correct app and WABA.
Webhook arrives, but signature verification fails.	The App Secret belongs to a different Meta app or was entered incorrectly.	Copy the App Secret from the same app that owns the webhook. Keep signature verification enabled.
Outbound replies stop later.	A temporary token expired.	Replace it with a System User token suitable for ongoing use.
One WABA works but another does not.	Phone Number ID and WABA ID were mixed between accounts.	Match the business, registered number, Phone Number ID, WABA ID, app, and token.



You are ready

When a message from another phone receives an AI reply and the portal shows **Receiving / Healthy**, your WhatsApp AI setup is complete.

Final security checklist

- ✓ Use a production System User token and keep it in VerityCore AI only.
- ✓ Keep webhook signature verification enabled.
- ✓ Give Meta users and system users only the access they need.
- ✓ Rotate any token or App Secret that appears in a screenshot, email, support ticket, or chat.
- ✓ Review Meta alerts, token validity, and VerityCore AI channel health regularly.

Need help? Contact your VerityCore AI administrator or support team. Never include access tokens or App Secrets in the request.